MEENA KANNAN

Meena Kannan - Staff Software Engineer - Apache Kafka & Cloud Streaming (INR 55L - 80L) | 9+ Yrs Java 21, Spring Boot 3, AWS/K8s/Kafka & Spring AI (Remote from India)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lead Software Engineer (9+ Yrs) tailored for Staff Software Engineer - Apache Kafka & Cloud Streaming (INR 55L - 80L) at Confluent. Proven ownership of cloud-native Java 21 & Spring Boot 3 microservices (VRLS 2.0 on AWS EKS/Istio/Kafka) and AI-augmented backend engineering (Spring AI, RAG, MCP). Available immediately from India for Global B2B Contract or Remote Full-Time.

SELECTED IMPACT & ARCHITECTURE HIGHLIGHTS

- Direct Stack Alignment (Confluent): Architected VRLS 2.0 microservices (Java 21, Spring Boot 3, AWS EKS, Istio mTLS, Kafka, KEDA, Redis).
- Cut redundant API calls by ~40% leading the Angular 13 to 18 (NgRx/RxJS) migration and instituted Scrum ADR governance.
- Slashed AI inference reporting delays from 15+ mins to near real-time using Apache Kafka event streams at BlackStraw.AI.
- Rolled out Spring AI, RAG vector pipelines, Model Context Protocol (MCP) tool servers, and sub-500ms Drools/AI rule engines.

CORE EXPERIENCE

Lead Software Engineer | NCS (Client: Land Transport Authority - VRLS 2.0) (Dec 2023 - Present)
Java 21, Spring Boot 3, AWS EKS/ECS, Istio mTLS, Kafka, KEDA, Redis, Angular 18 (-40% redundant API calls), ArgoCD, Spring AI & MCP.

Application Consultant | NCS (Client: LTA VRLS Platform) (Dec 2021 - Dec 2023)
Technical owner of live VRLS platform across 8 licensing modules (Java, Spring MVC, Oracle DB, Kafka, JMS).

Senior Software Engineer | BlackStraw.AI (India) (May 2021 - Nov 2021)
Built Spring Boot + Apache Kafka real-time AI inference pipelines cutting reporting delays from 15+ mins to near real-time.

Software Engineer | HDB Portal Systems (Aug 2019 - Dec 2020) & Wolters Kluwer LegalTech AI (Jul 2018 - Jul 2019)
Engineered sub-500ms AI + Drools BRMS legal billing compliance engine and HDB regulatory transaction workflows.